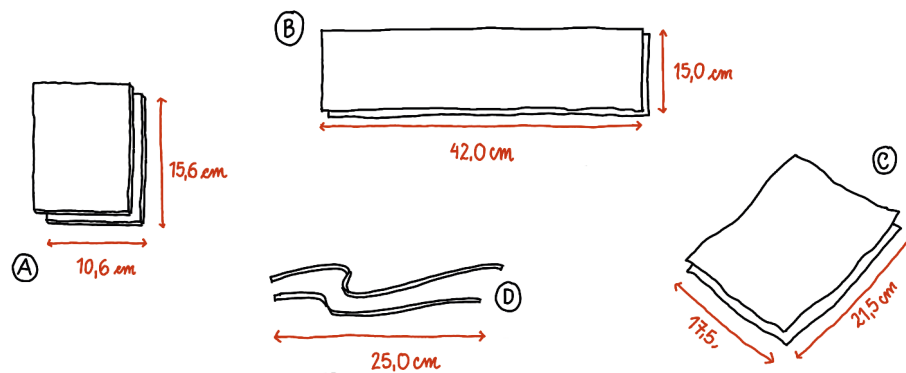


Making a concertina

MATERIALS

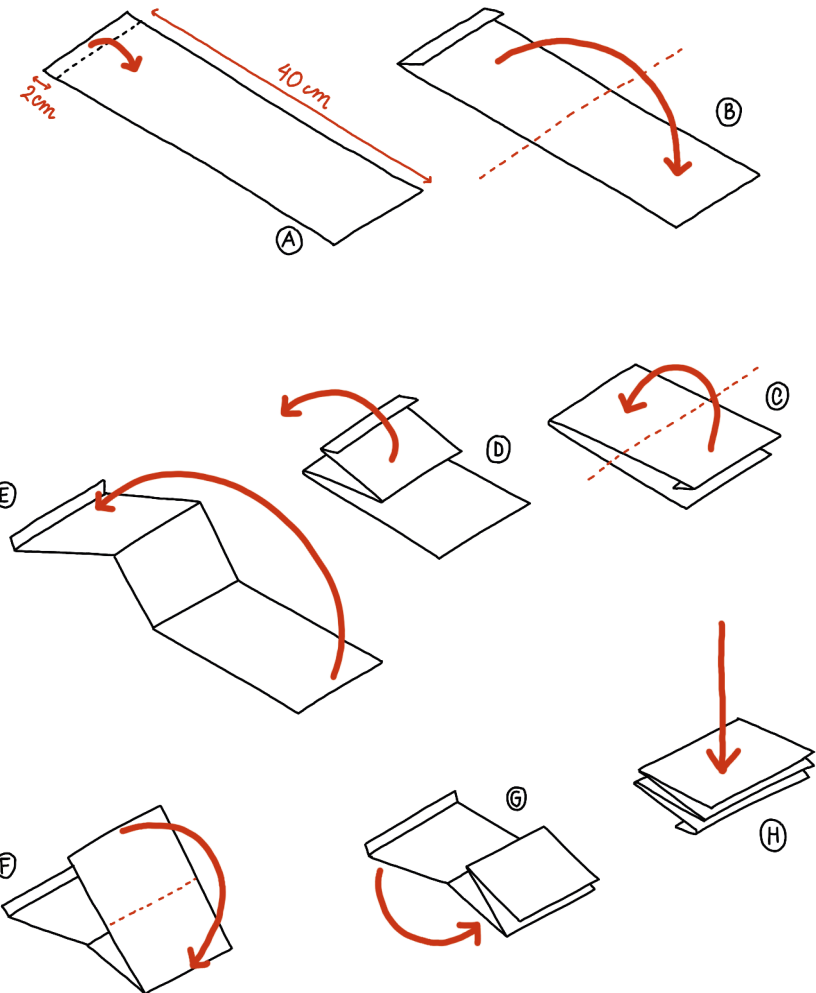
- A. 2x CARDBOARD, 15,6X10,6cm (choose thickness, I use 2mm)
- B. 2x THICK SHEETS OF PAPER, 42x15cm (or just one long one)
- C. 2x BOOK CLOTH, 21,5x17,5cm (in your favourite colour or patterns)
- D. 2x BANDS, 25cm, 1cm wide (I normally use satin, so I skip having to make a groove on the cardboard to fit the thick volume of the band)



1. UNDERSTAND THE PROJECT

Before you start any bookbinding project it's important that you decide and define the size of the book you want to make. In this case we are making a book block that will have the size of 15x10cm.

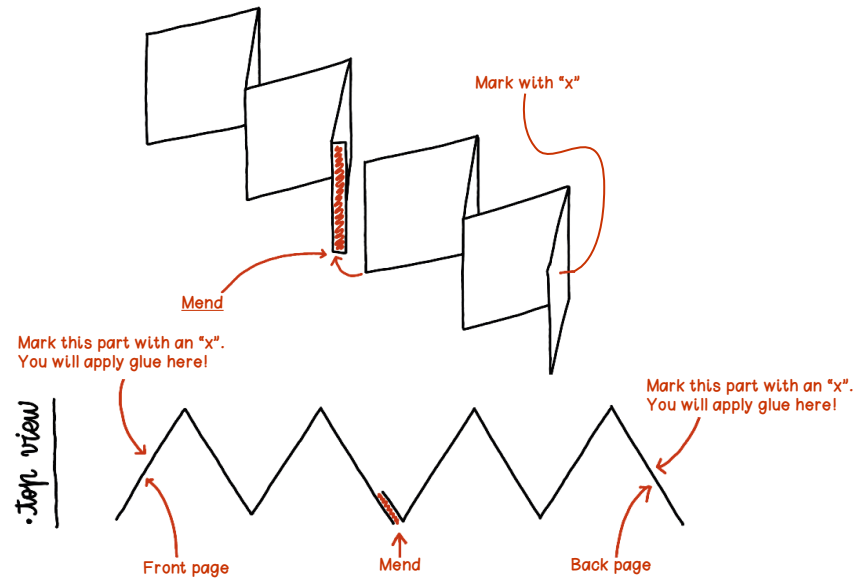
I know how hard it can be to find really long sheets of paper, even though 42cm is not that common size either. So what I normally do is that I always attach sheets together to get the final length I want.



2. FOLD THE SHEETS

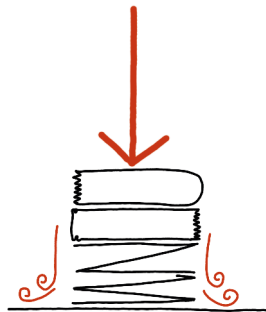
Fold the sheets by finding the halves like the diagram bellow show.

PS: Before you start, fold first the 2cm flap in one of the sheets. On the other sheet, remove 2cm (cut off). You only need one flap to glue together the sheets.



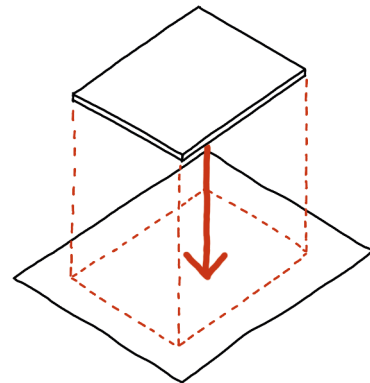
3. ATTACH THE SHEETS

Use glue to attach the sheets together. Make sure that the mend is on the inside.



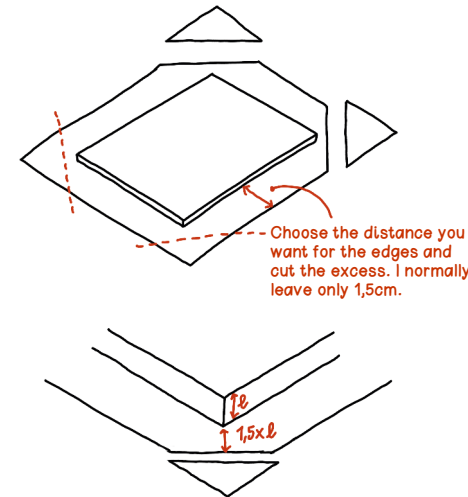
4. PUT SHEETS UNDER PRESS

Use your handmade presser or just some heavy books and press your sheets.



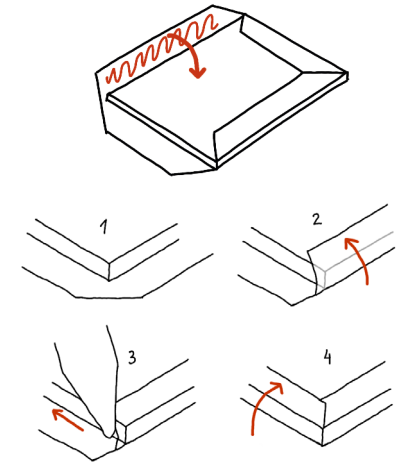
5. GLUE BOARDS ON FABRIC

Take the two cardboard sheets and line them with fabric to start preparing the covers.



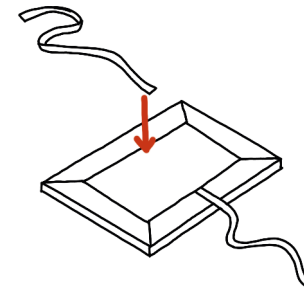
6. CUT CORNERS

Cut the corners before folding the fabric edges. You can use the help of a corner jig (mitering tool). The idea is to make a cut close to 45 degrees and to have the right distance from the boards.



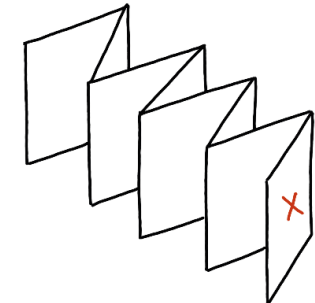
7. FOLD EDGES

Apply glue on the edges and fold them into the boards. Pay attention to the corners when folding the first two (top and bottom first), follow instructions.



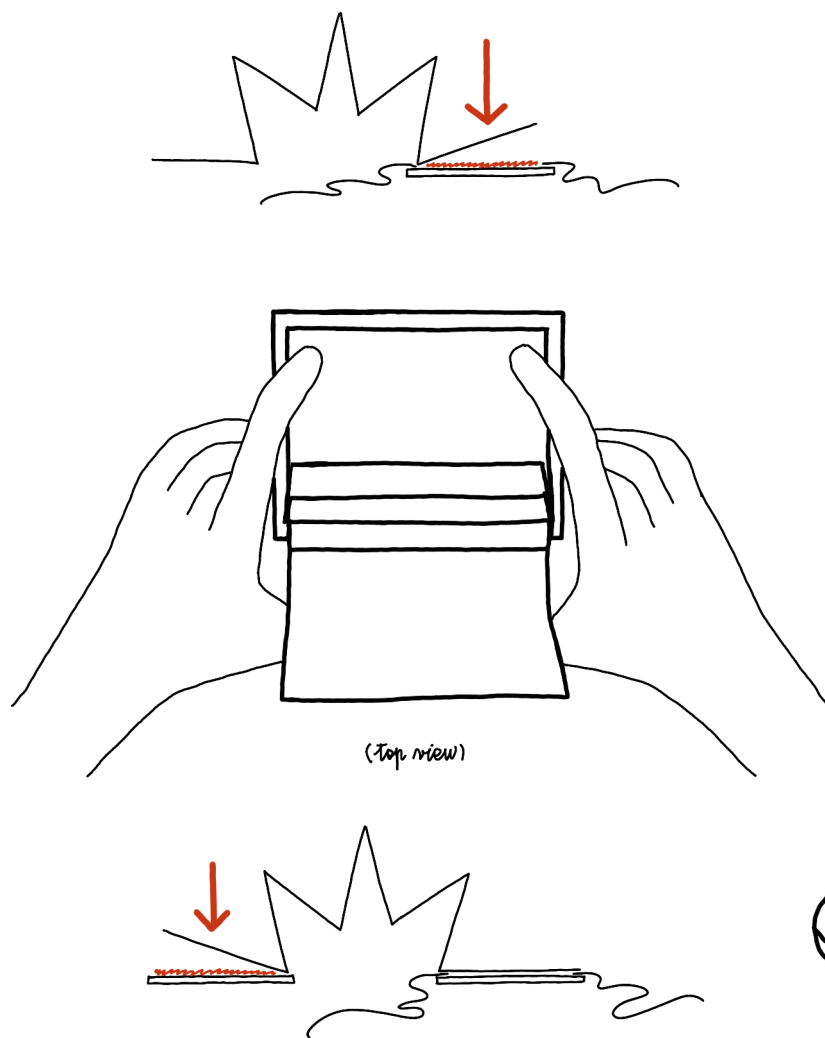
8. GLUE BANDS

Find the right height you want your closing bands to sit. The brands will set on the back cover.



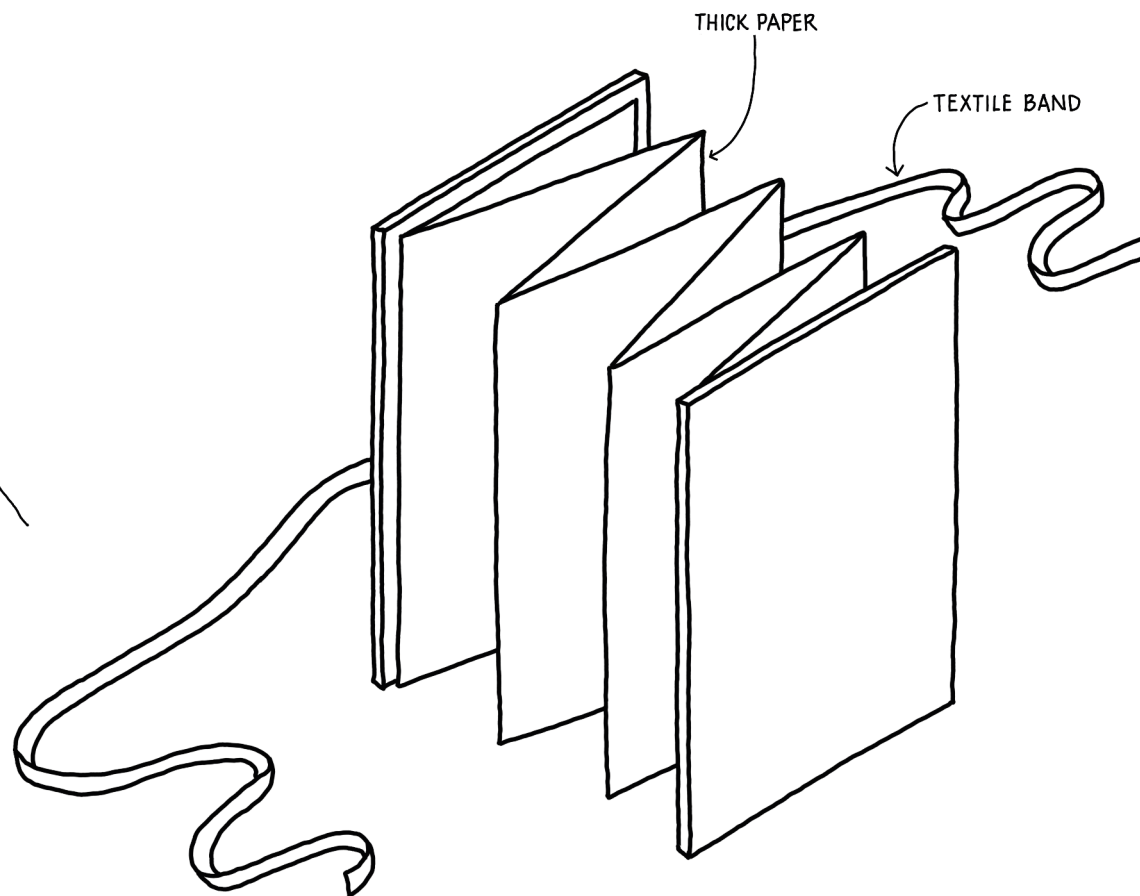
9. PREPARE YOUR SHEETS

Take your sheet out of the press and prepare to glue them to the covers.



10. GLUE FIRST SIDE DOWN

Glue one sheet at a time to the covers. Try to place the sheets as centred as possible.



11. PRESS YOUR FINAL BOOK

Congrats. Now you have made your first concertina! Leave the book under pressure for some hours before using.